

CUSTOMER SUCCESS CASE STUDY

HOW A GLOBAL CLOUD AND DATA CENTRE SOLUTIONS PROVIDER SCALED ITS MARKETING OPERATING MODEL

GROWING INTERNATIONAL TEAM CAPACITY WHILE COORDINATING PAID MEDIA, SEO, DESIGN, OPERATIONS AND DEMAND GENERATION

Organisation	Global cloud and data centre solutions provider
Period	March 2017 - March 2018
Role / scope	Chief Marketing Officer International marketing leadership across India, US and UK
Audience	CMOs, marketing leaders, CEOs and hiring managers

EXECUTIVE OUTCOME

The work directed and scaled an international marketing team from 8 to 20 people across India, the United States and the United Kingdom. This represented a documented 2.5x increase in team capacity. The operating model coordinated paid media, performance marketing, SEO, design, marketing operations and demand generation across geographies and agencies. The customer-success story is about building the people, roles and coordination required for global growth, rather than treating scale as simply adding campaigns.

METRIC REGISTER AND PUBLICATION STATUS

Each metric is either documented in the supplied profile/project material or marked as an illustrative validation item. Validation items are prompts for recovering the original baseline, denominator, source and attribution; they are not public claims.

Metric	Value	Definition	Status / publication note
Marketing team	8 to 20	Reported increase in international marketing team size.	Documented in supplied project material.
Team capacity	2.5x	Ratio of reported after team size to before team size.	Derived from documented team figures.
Regional pipeline	Validation required	Qualified pipeline contribution by India, US and UK.	Illustrative validation item - not a claim.

BUSINESS CONTEXT AND CUSTOMER CHALLENGE

The portfolio included public cloud, private cloud, hyper-converged technology, data-centre infrastructure management, SIEM and managed services for an international audience. These offerings required different messages, levels of technical depth and market contexts.

The challenge was scale with coherence. A larger footprint can create duplicated work, inconsistent positioning, unclear ownership and slow execution if the operating model does not evolve.

STRATEGIC DIAGNOSIS

Growth required capability architecture: strategy, product understanding, content, design, demand generation, performance marketing, operations and sales enablement, with clear interfaces to sales, solution architects, OEMs and agencies.

Scaling from 8 to 20 was not treated as headcount alone. It was a way to create coverage and specialisation while improving coordination and distributing responsibility.

CAMPAIGN SUCCESS MATRIX

The matrix makes the operating logic visible: business need, strategic move, execution system and success signal. It is deliberately designed for executive readers who want to understand how the work created a repeatable capability, not only a headline result.

Business need	Strategic move	Execution system	Success signal
Capacity	support a broader global portfolio	Functional coverage across marketing disciplines	2.5x reported team capacity
Coordination	reduce regional and functional silos	Role clarity, onboarding and coaching	More connected delivery
Technical trust	market complex solutions credibly	Solution architects, content and sales collaboration	Stronger propositions and assets
Governance	keep growth measurable	ROI, proposals, reporting and sales-process metrics	Executive visibility

APPROACH AND EXECUTION

1. 1. DESIGN THE CAPABILITY MAP

The first move was support a broader global portfolio. The role map clarified which capabilities were needed and where internal and agency expertise should meet. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. The role map clarified which capabilities were needed and where internal and agency expertise should meet. The work was reviewed through the lens of capacity, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. 2.5x reported team capacity The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

2. 2. SCALE PEOPLE AND RESPONSIBILITY

The first move was reduce regional and functional silos. Team growth was paired with ownership and decision rights so additional capacity could create output rather than dependency. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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3. 3. CONNECT TECHNICAL AND SALES TEAMS

The first move was market complex solutions credibly. Technical presentations, solution briefs, white papers, videos and knowledge assets supported buyer and seller needs. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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4. 4. ESTABLISH OPERATING DISCIPLINE

The first move was keep growth measurable. Reporting and commercial process made the larger team accountable to business outcomes, not only activity. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. Reporting and commercial process made the larger team accountable to business outcomes, not only activity. The work was reviewed through the lens of governance, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

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MEASUREMENT, ATTRIBUTION AND OPERATING DISCIPLINE

Team size documents scale, but it does not prove proportional productivity or revenue. Additional metrics such as regional pipeline, launch time, asset production and partner-sourced demand should be added only if verified.

A senior reader should be able to tell which evidence proves execution, which evidence proves engagement and which evidence proves commercial impact. The case therefore keeps metric definitions close to the story. Where the supplied material documents a practice-level or portfolio-level result, the narrative says so. Where a project-specific number is unavailable, the document names the recovery task instead of manufacturing precision.

BUSINESS IMPACT AND CUSTOMER-SUCCESS INTERPRETATION

The organisation gained a marketing function better suited to an international, technically complex portfolio. The team could support more programs and markets while preserving a global narrative with room for regional nuance.

For an executive reader, the story demonstrates leadership beyond campaign execution: building people, structure, collaboration, tools, process, reporting and commercial alignment.

WHAT THIS CASE DEMONSTRATES TO AN EXECUTIVE READER

- Scaling marketing requires capability design, not only hiring volume.
- Global consistency and regional relevance can coexist through clear operating principles.
- Technical marketing strengthens when solution experts and marketers co-create.
- Capacity should be reported separately from productivity and revenue.

End of case study